

NORTHERN HIGHLANDS AI CLUB

Leadership Accountability System

Blunt audit of the company-style proposal, plus a corrected operating model for Ben review

Item	Value
Prepared for	Reid Sendroff and Ben Shamosh
Prepared by	Codex, acting from the supplied research-engineer super prompt
Date	May 31, 2026
Source base	32 Markdown files, AI_Club_June1_Meeting_Plan.docx, AI_Club_Strategic_Plan_2026.docx
Limitation	AI Club Leadership Google Drive link was not provided, so live Drive context was not reviewed.

Bottom line: The instinct is right. The execution Claude produced is not ready to present. The corrected version should be framed as a leadership operating system, not a student-club HR department.

Super Prompt Executed

This is the prompt I used as the operating instruction for the audit and rewrite.

Act as a top research engineer in the top 0.1% of research engineers, with the judgment of an elite operator who has built high-accountability technical teams. Audit the proposed AI Club company-style leadership accountability section against all local AI Club context, the June 1 meeting plan, the strategic plan, and every Markdown file in the workspace. Be blunt. Identify every structural, operational, cultural, legal/school-context, incentive, timing, and language problem. Do not stop at criticism. Produce a corrected leadership accountability system that preserves the user's intent: leaders need written role criteria, dated deliverables, evidence-based review, a fair improvement process, and replacement when a role is not being performed. Translate corporate concepts into a student-appropriate operating system. Avoid performative HR language. Keep the bar high without creating public shame, favoritism, or advisor risk. Integrate with the existing AI Club OS: building club identity, 8-officer structure, 75% member participation floor, 90% leadership attendance expectation, bi-weekly scrums, Room 133 open lab, parent donation drive, API fund, competition calendar, and succession protocol. Return a usable document for Reid and Ben: executive verdict, precise failure list, corrected framework, role scorecards, dated implementation calendar, leadership improvement plan template, meeting-script language, and document-integration recommendations.

Files Actually Reviewed

- 32 Markdown files were enumerated and reviewed for AI Club context, including AI_Club_OS, AI_Club_Docs, AI_Club.md, CLAUDE.md, MEGA_CONTEXT.md, MASTER_PROMPT.md, and June1_Meeting_SuperPrompt.md.
- The current AI_Club_June1_Meeting_Plan.docx was extracted and reviewed, including Claude's added Part 1B.
- AI_Club_Strategic_Plan_2026.docx was extracted and reviewed because that was the DOCX named in the user context.
- Official Anthropic and OpenAI pages were checked only for the time-sensitive AI-tools claims in the existing June 1 plan.

Blunt Audit

Verdict: Claude did a decent first-pass brainstorm. It did not produce a safe operating policy. The current Part 1B is too corporate, under-specified where fairness matters, over-specified where incentives can backfire, and bolted into a meeting plan that no longer fits the clock.

What Claude Got Right

- It understood the real problem: leadership cannot be decorative if the club is going to survive without Reid doing the work.
- It correctly tied accountability to role-specific outputs instead of vague effort.
- It added a recovery process before removal, which is better than surprise replacement.
- It recognized succession as part of accountability, not a separate April-only event.

Everything Wrong Enough to Fix Before Ben Sees It

Problem	Why it matters
Agenda math is broken	The June 1 plan now runs about 75 minutes before real-world drift. Adding a 10-minute Part 1B without cutting Part 2 or Part 3 makes the document operationally false.
Wrong document target	The user context names AI_Club_Strategic_Plan_2026.docx, but Claude updated AI_Club_June1_Meeting_Plan.docx. That may be useful, but it ignores the explicit referenced file.
The phrase 'run it like a company' is dangerous if used raw	It will sound intense to Reid and Ben, but to members, parents, and an advisor it can sound like unpaid minors are being put through workplace discipline.
'PIP' language is the wrong surface language	Use Leadership Improvement Plan internally. Do not announce 'PIP' to a high school club unless the goal is to make everyone anxious and invite adult questions.
It violates the club's own language rules	The section uses em dashes and corporate language even though CLAUDE.md and the announcement system explicitly ban both across club output.
It creates an HR process without HR safeguards	There is no confidentiality model, appeal path, advisor role, documentation access rule, or definition of who can see performance records.
It puts the Secretary in the wrong job	Having the Secretary document officer performance reviews mixes neutral records with confidential personnel-style notes. Secretary can log artifacts and attendance, not private improvement plans.
The KPIs are shallow in places	Follower growth is a bad CMO metric. It incentivizes attention hunting. The real metric is whether every meeting is promoted clearly, on time, with specific demos and useful recaps.
It does not define evidence	Green, Yellow, and Red only work if each status maps to observable artifacts: agenda posted, attendance logged, ledger updated, blocker closed, post published.
It skips a coaching step	A company-style PIP is usually late-stage. For a student club, the first response should be a direct reset conversation and support plan before a formal improvement plan.
The replacement standard is	'Two Yellows to Red' ignores illness, school load, family issues, or role mis-scoping.

Problem	Why it matters
too abrupt	The process needs judgment, not a vending machine.
It creates weird rewards	'First pick of the best projects and competition teams' undermines balanced project-team formation and risks making leadership a status economy.
The bench idea is half-right but socially clumsy	Keeping runner-up applicants warm is smart. Calling them a bench can make members feel like backups. Use 'ready successors' or 'alternate candidates.'
It does not hold Presidents accountable	If the goal is systems, Reid and Ben need standards too: response time, advisor communication, admin asks, final approvals, and not filling delegated roles.
It does not integrate with the existing Leadership Failure Protocol	AI_Club_OS already has direct conversation, written note, then step-down or reassignment. The new model should upgrade that protocol, not create a competing one.
It ignores advisor and school-policy risk	Removal from leadership in a school club should be advisor-visible. Any formal written improvement plan should be reviewed by Mr. Novak before it starts.
It over-relies on monthly reviews	Monthly reviews are too slow for weekly operations. Use weekly artifact checks and monthly conversations.
It underuses the existing scrum system	Leadership accountability should be managed the same way member work is managed: visible commitments, next sprint, blocker log, evidence.
It does not define role charters	A one-page job description is mentioned but not actually specified. The corrected system needs a required charter template.
It is too much for the June 1 meeting	Members do not need the full policy in the room on June 1. Ben needs it. Members need the standard, the application process, and the fact that roles will be reviewed.

The Clean Diagnosis

- Claude solved the wrong layer. It wrote a motivational accountability section. The club needs an operating system.
- The policy must be enforceable from artifacts, not from vibes.
- The language needs to be high-standard but school-safe.
- The full framework belongs in the Strategic Plan / AI Club OS. The June 1 meeting gets a short version.

Corrected Framework

Rename it: Do not call this 'Running the Club Like a Company' in the final member-facing version. Call it the Leadership Operating System. Internally, Reid and Ben can keep the company analogy.

Operating Principle

Leadership in the AI Club is an operating role. Every officer owns a defined function, produces visible artifacts on a schedule, gets regular feedback, and can be reassigned if the role is not being performed. The point is not punishment. The point is to protect the club from becoming dependent on one or two people.

The Four Rules

- 1. Every role has a charter. Mission, weekly responsibilities, recurring deadlines, required artifacts, backup owner, and what Green performance looks like.
- 2. Performance is based on evidence. Agendas, posts, ledgers, attendance logs, blocker logs, and competition calendars count. Good intentions do not count by themselves.
- 3. Feedback is routine. Officers get weekly artifact checks, monthly role reviews, and marking-period status decisions.
- 4. Underperformance gets support first, then reassignment if needed. Direct reset, written improvement plan, advisor-visible review, role transition if the plan is not met.

Status System

Status	Meaning	Action
Green	Role is being performed reliably. Artifacts are on time and quality is acceptable.	Continue. Consider more ownership, public credit, or mentoring a successor.
Yellow	One or more expected artifacts are late, missing, weak, or repeatedly need rescue.	Direct reset conversation. Written next-step target due before the next review point.
Red	Core role function is not happening, or the same Yellow issue repeats after reset.	Leadership Improvement Plan. Advisor-visible. Clear deliverables and deadline.

Process Ladder

Step	When it happens	What happens
1. Direct reset	First meaningful miss	Co-President or VP/COO names the miss, asks what is blocking it, and sets the next concrete deliverable.
2. Written reset	Repeat miss or missed reset deliverable	Short written note: role standard, evidence, next deliverable, due date, support offered.
3. Leadership Improvement Plan	Core role failure or repeated Yellow	2 meeting cycles or 2 to 3 weeks. Specific recovery deliverables. Advisor is aware before it starts.
4. Role transition	Plan not met	Officer is reassigned or steps down. Successor or interim owner takes the charter within one week.

Role Scorecards

These scorecards are intentionally artifact-based. If the artifact exists and is good enough, the role is functioning. If not, it is not.

VP / Chief Operations Officer

Area	Green standard	Evidence
Agenda	Meeting agenda distributed to officers 48 hours before every meeting.	Shared agenda timestamp.
Room and AV	Room 133, screen, and meeting setup confirmed by lunch on meeting day.	Setup checklist.
Scrums	Every project team presents at least every two weeks, with time kept and commitments captured.	Scrum tracker.
Blockers	Team blockers logged within 24 hours and followed up within 5 school days.	Blocker log.
Team liaison	Each project team has a named VP/COO contact and receives at least one check-in between scrums.	Liaison notes.

CMO / Social Media Manager

Area	Green standard	Evidence
7AM hook	Posted or scheduled for every meeting, under the club's tone rules.	Post link or screenshot.
1PM reminder	Posted or scheduled with real agenda detail and Room 133 @ 2:45.	Post link or screenshot.
You Missed It	Posted within 3 hours of the meeting ending, based on what actually happened.	Post link or screenshot.
Content calendar	Next two meetings' content needs collected from VP/COO by the prior weekend.	Content calendar.
Quality	No generic hype, no fake polish, no off-brand sign-off, no missing demo specifics.	Co-President review notes.

Treasurer

Area	Green standard	Evidence
Ledger	Club ledger updated within 48 hours of every transaction.	Ledger timestamp.
Donation drive	September parent donation process prepared, launched, and closed with totals reported.	Donation tracker.

Area	Green standard	Evidence
API fund	Team API funds distributed at the start of Q2 after teams are scoped.	Distribution record.
Reimbursements	Approved reimbursements processed within 5 school days of receipt.	Reimbursement log.
Monthly report	Balance, spending, and risks shared with officers monthly.	Monthly report.

Secretary

Area	Green standard	Evidence
Attendance	Attendance logged within 24 hours of every meeting and open lab.	Attendance ledger.
Warnings	Members at or below 80% receive written notice within 3 school days.	Warning log.
Strike tracking	Scrum absences and no-progress exceptions tracked accurately.	Strike log.
Competition calendar	Semester competition calendar published in September and January.	Calendar link.
Minutes	Meeting decisions and action items posted within 24 hours.	Minutes doc.

Co-Presidents

Area	Green standard	Evidence
Delegation	Do not silently absorb delegated work. If an officer misses, use the process.	Weekly leadership notes.
Advisor relationship	Mr. Novak gets clear asks, risk updates, and policy changes before they surprise him.	Advisor update log.
Approvals	External communications and expenses over \$50 reviewed within 24 hours when possible.	Approval log.
Admin asks	Room 133, tool unblocks, parent donation process, and GitHub/Drive infrastructure moved forward.	Admin tracker.
Succession	Potential successors identified by February and shadowing starts by March.	Succession tracker.

Leadership Improvement Plan Template

Use internally: For members, say 'improvement plan' or 'role reset.' Do not brand this as a PIP in announcements.

Field	What to write
Officer / role	Name and exact role.
Role standard missed	Quote the charter standard, not a vague complaint.
Evidence	What artifact was missing, late, incomplete, or rescued by someone else.
Impact	What broke or almost broke because of it.
Recovery deliverables	1 to 3 concrete outputs, each with a due date.
Support	Who will help, when they will check in, and what blocker will be removed.
Timeline	Normally two meeting cycles or 2 to 3 weeks. Adjust for school breaks.
Review owner	One Co-President, with Mr. Novak aware for role-removal risk.
Outcomes	Met: return to Green or Yellow with monitoring. Not met: role reassignment or transition.
Privacy	Stored only in the leadership folder. Not discussed publicly. Secretary logs only final role-status changes.

Example

- Role: CMO.
- Standard missed: three-post system for every meeting.
- Evidence: 1PM reminder missed twice in three meetings; You Missed It posted 28 hours late.
- Recovery deliverables: publish full three-post set for the next two meetings, drafts due to Reid and Ben by Sunday 8 PM before each meeting.
- Support: VP/COO sends agenda details by Saturday noon; Reid reviews draft by Sunday night.
- Outcome: if both cycles hit, CMO returns to Green. If one is missed without prior communication, role transitions to alternate candidate or interim owner.

Implementation Calendar

Date / window	Action
June 1	Announce leadership applications and the fact that leadership roles will have written expectations next year. Do not present the full accountability policy.
June 8	Applications close. Candidates identify target role.
June 10	Recorded demo deadline for candidates not presenting live.
June 15	Candidate demos. Evaluate project quality plus role fit.
June 16	Decisions announced privately first, then to the club.
June 17	New leadership Discord/server channel opens. Each officer receives a draft charter.
August	Reid and Ben finalize role charters, scorecards, Drive folders, templates, and advisor review.
September Week 1	Leadership kickoff. Officers sign charters. Member onboarding and interest forms begin.
September Week 2-3	Project teams formed. VP/COO liaisons assigned. Parent donation drive active.
October	First full scrum cycle. API funds distributed after teams are stable. First monthly officer review.
November	First formal status review before Congressional App Challenge deadline pressure peaks.
December	Mid-year review: role fit, attendance, financial reconciliation, team health.
January	Second-semester reset and new competition calendar.
February-March	Successor identification and shadowing conversations begin.
April-May	Officer elections, transition documents, incoming-officer shadowing.
June	Full handoff. Old officers become available advisors, not hidden operators.

What to Say on June 1

Keep it short: The June 1 meeting should not become a policy seminar. The message is the standard, not the machinery.

Suggested script:

Next year, leadership is going to work differently. Every officer role will have a written job description, specific weekly responsibilities, and real review points during the year. If someone takes a leadership role and the work is not getting done, we are going to address it directly, support them, and if it still does not change, move someone else into the role. That is not meant to be harsh. It is the only way this club becomes bigger than Reid and Ben. Leadership here has to mean ownership.

Where This Belongs

Document	Recommendation
AI_Club_Strategic_Plan_2026.docx	Add a condensed Leadership Operating System section after Organizational Structure or Participation & Accountability. This is the right admin/advisor-facing home.
AI_Club_June1_Meeting_Plan.docx	Replace the current 10-minute Part 1B with a 3 to 5 minute leadership-standard note, or cut Part 2/Part 3 enough to make the agenda real.
AI_Club_OS/02_Leadership_and_Roles.md	Replace the existing Leadership Failure Protocol with the upgraded ladder: direct reset, written reset, improvement plan, role transition.
AI_Club_OS/04_Member_System.md	Keep member attendance and strike policy separate from officer performance. Do not mix member discipline and officer role review.
AI_Club_OS/10_Succession_Protocol.md	Add ready-successor logic for mid-year officer replacement.

Ben Review Checklist

These are the questions Reid and Ben should answer before anything is shown to members.

- Are we comfortable enforcing role transitions mid-year, or only at semester boundaries except for major misses?
- What role does Mr. Novak need to play before a leader is removed?
- Who can see improvement plans? Recommended answer: Reid, Ben, the officer, and Mr. Novak if removal is possible.
- Do we want 90% leadership attendance as a hard standard, or a Green standard with exceptions?
- Should current officers reapply through the same project-demo process, or submit role-specific evidence instead?
- What is the exact replacement path if no alternate candidate is ready?
- How do we avoid making leadership feel like status while still making it meaningful?
- Which parts go into the Strategic Plan, and which parts stay internal to the Leadership OS?

Final Recommendation

Keep the ambition. Replace the corporate costume. The club should operate like a serious technical team: clear ownership, visible artifacts, short feedback loops, documented support, and role transition when a function is not being performed. That is strong. Calling it a company with KPIs and PIPs is weaker than the underlying idea and easier for people to attack.